



27 Influential Penetration Testers

Who are
making the
world safer



Compiled by Evgeny Belenky & Basheer Ahmed Khan

We have listed **27 Influential Penetration Testers** who are making the world much safer.

Special thanks to **InfosecTDK** (Moderator, Peerlyst) for proof reading and editing the content.

Alyssa Miller	Bryan McAninch
Charles Dardaman	Chintan Gurjar
Chloe Messdaghi	Chris Roberts
Chris Nickerson	D Mohammadbagher
Derek Rook	HonInbo
James Smith	Jesse Kinser
Jos Wetzels	Marina Krotofil
Mark Clayton	Moshe Zioni
Paula Januszkiewicz	Philip Young
Phillip Wylie	Stephanie SCarruthers
Tanya Janca	Terran Leake
Tim Medin	Tinker
Vandana Verma	Weston Hecker
Wirefall	

Alyssa Miller



Alyssa is a hacker, blue-teamer, public speaker, and security evangelist with over 15 years of experience in the security industry. A former developer, she has focused heavily on application security over the years, not only conducting application assessments, threat modelling exercises, and secure code reviews, but also working with companies to develop secure SDLC programs. Alyssa specializes in helping organizations design and deploy effective security programs and has performed instructor led application security training.

Alyssa speaks regularly at industry and vendor conferences and has appeared on multiple security industry podcasts. She is also a chapter leader for Women of Security (WoSEC), an organization committed to making the security community a welcoming place for women.



Alyssa Miller



Currently, Alyssa is the Manager of the Information Security Solutions Practice for CDW, leading a team of architects building security assessment and advisory solutions for customers. Alyssa has been featured in multiple security publications and also holds a CISM certification from ISACA.



Bryan McAninch



Bryan McAninch is a cybersecurity professional with over twenty years' experience in various disciplines including digital forensics, penetration testing, and security architecture. His current area of research is focused on the security implications of cloud, container, and artificial intelligence technologies.

He holds a Bachelor of Science in Business Administration from the University of Texas at Dallas and a Master of Science in Cybersecurity from the University of Dallas. Additionally, he is CISSP, SANS GPEN, SABSA CSA, and AWS CSA certified.

Bryan is passionate about cybersecurity and giving back to the community. He is an organizer of the North Texas Cyber Security Group, member of the Dallas Hackers Association, SANS instructor, Frisco ISD mentor, and founder of Prevade Cybersecurity.



Charles Dardaman



Charles Dardaman is an Information Security professional with over 5 years of experience in both offense and defense. Currently working as a penetration tester, he has held security jobs in malware reverse engineering and web application security. He is also an active member of the local security community and a frequent speaker at local events.

Charles spends a lot of his free time looking for vulnerabilities and often collaborates with others in the community to find and release 0 days. His recent focus has been on IOT devices and has earned multiple CVEs in the past year.



Chintan Gurjar



Chintan is a manager at KPMG New Zealand's Cyber Security Services practice with a strong technical focus. 8 years of experience critical-thinking security professional working as a 'hybrid specialist' covering both the broad and deep technical area of cybersecurity and the management part of information security to protect organizations against targeted attacks from APTs and digital (cyber) criminals. Striving to apply security best practices to raise the security maturity level way above average and high, Chintan has the ability to assess the technical risks of the client's business and relate that into pragmatic risk management in terms of business context. He has been involved in a range of technical security projects mainly focused:

- Application Security Testing (Web, API, Android, iOS)
- Cyber Threat Intelligence



Chintan Gurjar



- Red Teaming
- Security Assessment and Review
- Penetration Testing
- Architecture Security Review
- Vulnerability Assessment
- Cyber Maturity Assessment
- Threat Hunting
- Secure Coding Review
- MITRE ATT&CK

Prior to KPMG, Chintan worked for NotSoSecure, a boutique British security consultancy. He has been a security engineer for Zebpay, Bitcoin, and Blockchain software development company. Chintan has 6 years of deep technical experience in conducting security assessments and reviews. Chintan is graduated from India in Computer Engineering (B.Tech) and post-graduated from UK in Computer Security and Forensics.



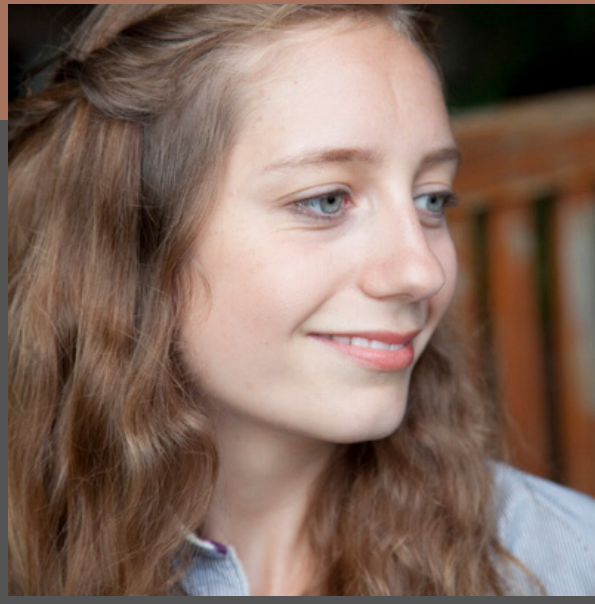
Chintan Gurjar



Chintan holds transferable skills in cloud security, SCADA environment security, shadow IT, security quality assurance, and malware analysis. He regularly blogs at infosecninja.blogspot.com.



Chloe Messdaghi

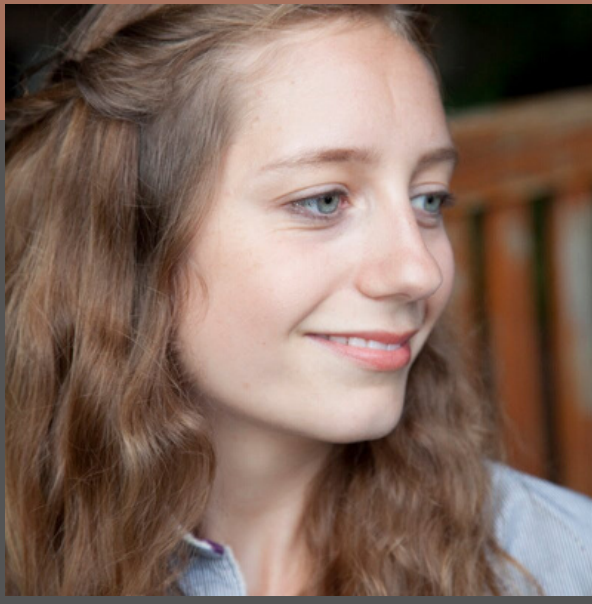


Chloe Messdaghi is a Security Researcher Advocate. Since entering cybersecurity space, she sees security as a humanitarian issue. Humanitarian work includes advising as a UN Volunteer, serving as a board member for several humanitarian organizations and started a non-profit called Drop Labels. Besides her passion to keep people safe and empowered online & offline, she is driven to change the statistics of women in InfoSec. She co-founded Women in Security (WoSEC) and heads the SF Bay Area chapter. In addition, she created WomenHackerz, an online community for women who hack at all levels, which also provides workshops training of all areas hacking for hundreds of women around the world.

In her spare time, she mentors women in infosec to enter and remain and gives talks on diversity and inclusion in InfoSec, bug bounty, mental health for hackers, and safe harbor.



Chloe Messdaghi



She holds a BA in International Relations from UC Davis, MS in Political Research from University of Edinburgh, and executive education from Wharton.



Chris Roberts



Chris is currently the CSS for Attivo Networks, and is working on a number of projects within the deception and services space. Over the years, he's founded or worked with a number of companies specializing in DarkNet research, intelligence gathering, cryptography, deception technologies, and providers of security services and threat intelligence.

Since the late 90's Chris has been deeply involved with security R&D, consulting, and advisory services in his quest to protect and defend businesses and individuals against cyber attack. Prior to that he jumped out of planes for a living, visiting all sorts of interesting countries and cultures while doing his best to avoid getting shot at too often. (Before that he managed to get various computers confiscated by a number of European entities.)



Chris Roberts



Roberts is considered one of the world's foremost experts on counter threat intelligence and vulnerability research within the Information Security industry. Roberts has led or been involved in information security assessments and engagements for the better part of 20 years, and has a wealth of experience with regulations such as GLBA, HIPAA, HITECH, FISMA, and NERC/FERC. He has also worked with government, state and federal authorities on standards such as CMS, ISO, and NIST.

Roberts is credentialed in many of the top IT and information security disciplines and as a CyberSecurity advocate and passionate industry voice, Roberts is regularly featured in national newspapers, television news, industry publications and several documentaries. He can typically be found waving arms on a stage somewhere on this planet...or hacking into whatever's taken his fancy...



Chris Roberts



As one of the well-known hackers and researchers, Chris is routinely invited to speak at industry conferences. CNN, The Washington Post, WIRED, Business Insider, USA Today, Forbes, Newsweek, BBC News, Wall Street Journal, and numerous others have covered him in the media.

And worst case, to jog the memory, Chris was the researcher who gained global attention in 2015 for demonstrating the linkage between various aviation systems, both on the ground and while in the air that allowed the exploitation of attacks against flight control systems.



Chris Nickerson



Chris Nickerson, CEO of Lares, has spent the last 20 years of his career leading, inspiring, and sometimes irritating, the security industry. With Lares co-Founder Eric M. Smith, he created the unique methodology used at Lares to assess, implement, and manage information security realistically and effectively. Collaborating with a group of other InfoSec researchers, he founded the Penetration Testing Execution Standard (PTES), and is working with the Red Team Alliance Training Collective to create a certification for Red Team Testing. He is one of the founders of the Security BSides conferences, he's been a keynote, speaker, and/or trainer at more than fifty InfoSec conferences worldwide, including DEFCON, CyberWeek, and BlackHat. He's a member and certification holder with ISACA, on the board of CREST, and holds CISSP, CISA, BS7799, and NSA IAM certifications.



Chris Nickerson



His book, Red Team Testing, is upcoming from Elsevier/Syngress. And despite all that, he is perhaps best known for his appearance on the TV show Tiger Team on TruTV, and his TED Talk, Hackers are all about curiosity, and security is just a feeling.



D Mohammadbagher



Damon is a Security Researcher & C# Developer + Windows Admin but loves working with Linux "always".

He has authored a book: "Bypassing AVs by C# Programming" & he has written articles about Attack/Defense (especially about Anti-viruses).

He is currently working on an ebook concurrently writing new articles about Attack/Defense. He is also developing some tools (frameworks) about Attack/Defense in C#. His ultimate aim is to educate and train about Cyber Security / Security Research.

His hobbies include music, simple and useful code, bypassing antiviruses, windows security and Linux.



Derek Rook



Derek didn't have a direct path into infosec. A web development internship in high school solidified his intention to go into tech, but without formal education or experience he floundered. Bouncing between help desk and manual labour and construction jobs, it took years before his break into systems administration and engineering. With a persistence bordering on stubborn, Derek attributes his current success to his diverse work background and the people he met along the way. "Be the person that younger you needed" as a guiding principal, he now strives to give back to the community. In addition to building free instructional material and challenges on youtube and other platforms he gives non-industry security talks in his local community. Derek also mentors and holds offensive security workshops for a local, women created and led community college information security club for career changers.



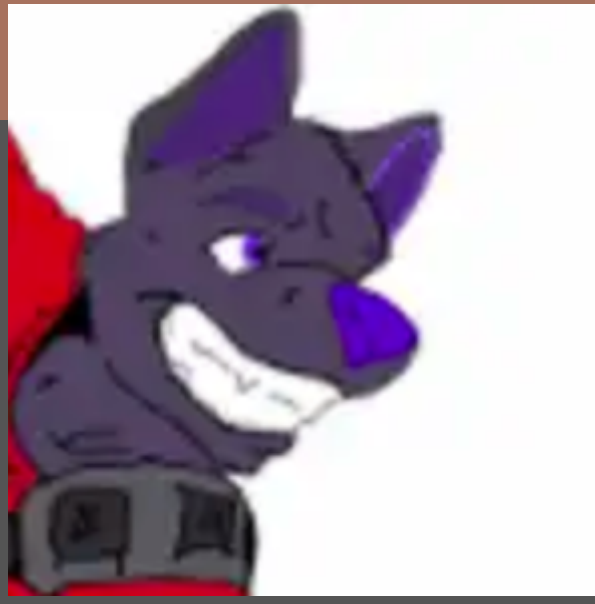
Derek Rook



With over fifteen years of tech experience Derek now works as an offensive security engineer, team lead, and educator. When not co-ordinating engagements, he can be found relentlessly spewing positivity and encouragement on twitter, teaching ethical hacking for SANS, or participating in whatever hacking challenges he can get his hands on. A two time NetWars Tournament of Champions winner and NolaCon black badge holder, he's taken a step back from competing to focus more on mentoring and uplifting others to help create a more diverse and inclusive community.



Hon1nbo

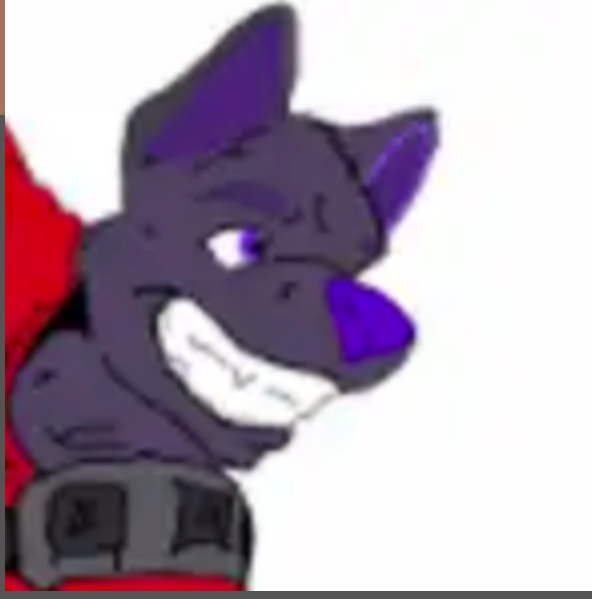


Hon1nbo is a hacker who tinkers for fun and to satisfy the basic human need to light things on fire. Hon1nbo allegedly has a job, where they get paid to take selfies in other people's secure vaults in the middle of the night. We don't know if this job is real, or merely a cover story. This possible delusion has taken them around the world entering into some of the largest organizations in both people size and technical expanse, using every possible entry method at their disposal. No domain left without an admin, no email left without a phish, and every office a wolf tail hiding in the air vents.

In addition to their night job, Hon1nbo runs Hacking & Coffee, a small hosting firm in Texas, where excess network capacity abounds, to perform security research and mirror F/OSS repositories. They also provide infrastructure support to a variety community projects, small businesses, and student groups.



Hon1nbo



A wild Hon1nbo can be spotted at DEF CON, its natural habitat, and identified via their purple tail, ears, and getting into shenanigans.



James Smith



Principal Security Consultant and Practice Lead with a deep technical background and passion for all things related to Cyber Security and Technology.

James is Bridewell's Penetration Testing Lead and brings a significant amount of knowledge and experience to the team. James is a hands on penetration tester who is also responsible for shaping the teams methodologies, developing new services and has responsibility for the quality of technical services delivered. James is also able to combine his vast technical knowledge with a personable approach that enables him to communicate with all levels within an organisation, sometimes explaining complex things in simple terms.

James has operated in various industries, performing penetration testing in various industries such as government (as a CHECK team member),



James Smith



retail, financial services through to industrial control systems and the aviation industry. This vast experience has allowed James to develop strong technical security assessments across a variety of technologies and act as a mentor for his team members, ensuring that they are supported in their development needs and security career.

James is also extremely passionate about technology and actively participates in industry initiatives where possible. James operates as a UK Fedora Ambassador, ensuring that the public understand what the project is trying to achieve and grow the contributor base.



Jesse Kinser



Recently featured as one of the World's Top 100 Hackers on NBC Nightly News, Jesse has over 10 years of professional information security experience and has worked in security roles in both the US gov and private industry. She is an active top ranked hacker on multiple bug bounty platforms and routinely presents on various security topics at leading conferences around the world.



Jos Wetzels



Jos Wetzels is a security researcher and consultant specializing in embedded systems security. His research and consultancy work has involved reverse-engineering, vulnerability research and exploit development across various domains ranging from industrial and automotive systems to IoT, networking equipment and deeply embedded SoCs. He previously worked as a researcher at the Distributed and Embedded Security group (DIES) at the University of Twente (UT) in the Netherlands where he developed exploit mitigation solutions for constrained Industrial Control Systems (ICS) devices used in critical infrastructure. He performed security analysis of state-of-the-art network and host-based intrusion detection systems and has been involved in research projects regarding on-the-fly detection and containment of unknown malware and Advanced Persistent Threats.



Jos Wetzels



He has spoken at various international security conferences such as Black Hat, DEF CON, USENIX Enigma, Chaos Communication Congress, REcon, OffensiveCon, CanSecWest, Infiltrate, hardware.io, TROOPERS and Swiss Cyber Storm.



Marina Krotofil



Marina Krotofil is an Industrial Control Systems (ICS) Senior Security Engineer at a large chemical company.

The last decade she spent on specializing on offensive ICS security such as discovering and weaponizing unique attack vectors, engineering damage scenarios, developing exploits and understanding attacker techniques when exploiting ICS. Offensive security skills serve Marina well during incident responses and forensic investigations, ICS malware analysis and when engineering defences.

She previously worked as a Principal Analyst and Subject Matter Expert (SME) in Cyber-Physical group at FireEye (USA), Lead Cyber Security Researcher at Honeywell (USA) and as a Senior Security Consultant at the European Network for Cyber Security (Netherlands).



Marina Krotofil



She authored more than 25 academic papers and book chapters on ICS security and is a frequent speaker at the leading security events around the world (5xBlack Hat, 2xDEF CON, 2xHITB, 4xSAS, 4xS4, CCC, ZeroNights and many others). She holds MBA in Technology Management, MSc in Telecommunication and MSc in Information and Communication Systems.



Mark Clayton



Mark Clayton (Bullz3ye) is a red teamer, security engineer, and application developer who and can't seem to choose between the three. Professionally he is a red teamer and security engineer, but is always developing web and mobile applications at night. Since a young age, he was under the mentorship of a Cult of the Dead Cow (cDc) member, who showed him the ropes and taught him the security ecosystem and he's stayed true to those lessons. Lately, he has focused on applying his offensive capabilities within an organization for threat hunting and incident response.



Moshe Zioni aka dalmoz



Moshe has been doing his thing for 20+ years. Started as a teenager, in a community comprised of Israeli and US hackers of the 90's, which is when he was studying and walking the path of attackers and defenders, devouring any text and code he could lay his hands on. Found home for his talents through his military service.

In turn, as a civilian, for a consistent traffic of Pen Testing and consultancy work for Comsec Global Group in many aspects on information security through 10 more years - including web applications, OS, reverse engineering, cryptography, network-level attacks and more ('cyber' was introduced to the common vocabulary somewhere within those years), and bringing up and managing group of elites for cutting-edge commando-style red/purple teaming to many customers.



Moshe Zioni aka dalmoz



For the past 10 years Moshe has been focusing on cyber research groups and delivering security products on several positions. Nowadays Moshe is the Director of Threat Research at Akamai, overseeing the security research teams' work that translates into Akamai's cloud security solutions. algorithms and logics.

Throughout Moshe's career he has been contributing back to the community which spawned him by speaking globally about different research work of his, publishing blogs and articles and disclosing bugs and some lot of CVEs to many firms, big and small.

Also, he co-founded ShabbatCon, an event taking place at DefCon for the 5th year now and have been speaking on many stages, including BlackHat, CCC, Hack-in-Paris, InfoSec Europe, universities, enterprises and local communities.



Paula Januszkiewicz



Paula Januszkiewicz is Security Expert, Penetration Tester, Trainer and the founder and CEO of CQURE, an IT and Cybersecurity consulting and educational company which predominantly conducts IT security audits and penetration testing. Founded in Poland in 2007, CQURE now has presence in the UAE, US and Switzerland.

Paula is also Cloud and Datacenter Management Microsoft MVP, honorable Microsoft Regional Director for CEE and a world class cybersecurity expert, consulting Customers all around the world. Paula is also a top speaker at global conferences including Microsoft Ignite (she was rated No. 1 among 1,100 speakers at a conference with 26,000 attendees), RSA (in 2017 in USA her two sessions were amongst the five hottest sessions), Black Hat (in 2019, Paula's presentation was voted best of Black Hat Asia 2019 Briefings!) or Gartner Security



Paula Januszkiewicz



Summit. Her presentations gather thousands of people.

Paula holds an MBA from Harvard Business School and has an access to source code of Windows – an honor given to just few people around the world!



Philip Young



Philip Young, aka Soldier of FORTRAN, is a leading expert in all things mainframe hacking. Having spoken and taught at conferences around the world, including DEFCON, RSA, BlackHat and keynoting at both SHARE and GSE Europe, he has established himself as the thought leader in mainframe penetration testing. Since 2013 Philip has released tools to aid in the testing of mainframe security and contributed to multiple open-source projects including Nmap, allowing those with little mainframe capabilities the chance to test their mainframes. In addition to speaking, he has built mainframe security programs for multiple Fortune 100 organizations starting from the ground up to creating a repeatable testing program using both vendor and public toolsets. His hope is that through raising awareness about mainframe security more organizations will take their risk profile seriously.



Phillip Wylie



Phillip Wylie is a Principal Information Security Engineer on the U.S. Bank Assessment Services Pen Test Team, an adjunct instructor teaching ethical hacking and web application pen testing at Richland College in Dallas, TX. Phillip is the founder of The Pwn School Project, an educational meetup with a focus on ethical hacking and pen testing. Phillip is a Bugcrowd Ambassador and the 2019 Ambassador of the year.

Phillip has over 21 years of IT and information security experience. He got his start as a sysadmin where he spent six years before moving into a network security role. After working in network security for a brief time, Phillip moved into application security. During his time as an application security analyst he performed vulnerability scans on web applications and managed third party pen tests.



Phillip Wylie



Working in application security is what developed his interest in pen testing. In 2012 he went to work as a consultant performing pen tests. Phillip has spent the past seven-plus years pen testing networks, wireless networks, and applications. Phillip has a passion for sharing information, mentoring, and teaching, which drew him into teaching and founding The Pwn School Project. Phillip holds the following certifications; CISSP, GWAPT, OSCP.



Stephanie Carruthers



Stephanie “Snow” Carruthers is a professional liar performing Social Engineering as a Service for her clients. Stephanie specializes in using her Social Engineering skills to perform a variety of assessments, including OSINT, phishing, vishing, covert entry, and red team exercises. She works with clients of all sizes from start-ups to Fortune 100 companies from all industries as well as government agencies. Since 2014, Stephanie has presented and taught at numerous security conferences and private events around the world.

For fun, Stephanie has earned black badges for winning the “Social Engineering Capture the Flag” (SECTF) at DEF CON 22 and also “The Vault” a physical security competition at SAINTCON 2017. Stephanie also enjoys travelling the world to see beautiful locations and meet new people, like Larry, who just let her into your data center.



Tanya Janca



Tanya Janca, also known as SheHacksPurple, is a senior cloud advocate for Microsoft, specializing in application and cloud security; evangelizing software security and advocating for developers and operations folks alike through public speaking, her open source project OWASP DevSlop, and various forms of teaching via workshops, blogs, public speaking and community events. As an ethical hacker, OWASP Project Leader, Women of Security (WoSEC) chapter leader, software developer and professional computer geek of 20+ years, she is a person who is truly fascinated by the 'science' of computer science.



Terran Leake



Terran Leake is a Penetration Tester on Amazon's Offensive Security Team. Her passion and focus is in application security. In her current role, she performs security testing to identify vulnerabilities within her company's products and services.

Terran began her career 10 years ago working a Systems Administrator for the Department of Defense and has gained experience working in multiple industries including tech, healthcare and finance. Aside from breaking applications, she enjoys reading about old and new exploit techniques as well as mentoring and training aspiring pen testers.



Tim Medin



Tim Medin is the founder and Principal Consultant at Red Siege. Tim is also a Principal SANS Instructor, the SANS MSISE Program Director and a SANS course author (course lead for SEC560: Network Penetration Testing and Ethical Hacking). Tim is the creator of Kerberoasting, a technique to extract kerberos tickets in order to offline attack the passwords of enterprise service accounts. Through the course of his career, Tim has performed penetration tests on a wide range of organizations and technologies. He gained information security experience in a variety of industries including previous positions in control systems, higher education, financial services, and manufacturing. Tim is an experienced international speaker, having presented to organizations around the world. Tim earned his MBA through the University of Texas.



Tinker



Tinker is a full scope penetration tester with experience in testing and bypassing the security of logical, physical, and social environments. He has conducted pentests and red team operations in the United States, Canada, and Europe. Tinker has built up, managed, and trained red team and penetration testing teams. Prior to this, Tinker served in the SOC trenches as an Intrusion Detection Analyst. Prior to that, he served in the United States Marine Corps.

He is known for giving red team story narratives that focus on both exploiting corporate vulnerabilities and the struggles to bypass corporate security. He is especially known for providing examples of when the Blue Team has kicked the Red Team's arse. His stories have been featured on multiple podcasts including Rally Security, Purple Squad Security, ThugCrowd, and Darknet Diaries.



Vandana Verma



Vandana is a seasoned security professional with over 14 years of experience ranging from application security to infrastructure and now dealing with DevSecOps.

She has been a keynote speaker at OWASP Global AppSec DC, 2019 and Cyber Security Career Conference 2020. She has spoken and trained at various conferences AppSec Europe, AppSec USA, IBM Security Summit, NullCon, Security Guild 2019, BSides Delhi, c0c0n (Kerala Police Conference), Global AppSec Tel Aviv and Blackhat US 2019. She is part of the crew for OWASP Seaside and BSides Delhi conferences. She also does CFP Reviews for AppSec Europe, Global AppSec Tel Aviv, Global AppSec DC and Grace Hopper US 2019 (Security/Privacy Review Track).

She has received Global cybersecurity influencer among IFSEC Global's "Top Influencers in Security



Vandana Verma



and Fire" Category for 2019. She recently received Cybersecurity Women of the year award by Women Cyberjutsu Society in the Category "Secure Coder". She has also been listed as one of the top women leaders in this field of technology and cybersecurity in India by Instasafe.

She works with various communities (InfosecGirls, OWASP (Global Board of Directors), WoSec and null) and is passionate about increasing female participation in Infosec space. She has trained over 3500 Diversity Participants around the globe on information Security.



Weston Hecker



Weston Hecker has been pen-testing for 15 years and has 17 years of experience doing security research and programming. Focusing on ICS Industrial control systems (MSI) Mission Secure Inc. Weston has recently spoken at Blackhat 2016, Defcon 22, 23,24,25 and 27 Enterprise Connect 2016, ISC2-Security Congress, SC-Congress Toronto, BSIDESBoston, HOPE 11 and at over 50 other speaking engagements from telecom regional events to Universities on security subject matter. Weston works with a major university's research project with Department of Homeland Security on 911 emergency systems and attack mitigation. He attended school in Minneapolis Minnesota and studied Computer Science and Geophysics. Weston found several vulnerabilities in very popular software and firmware, including Microsoft, Qualcomm, Samsung, HTC and Verizon.



Wirefall



Wirefall is the founder of the Dallas Hackers Association (DHA), a monthly “mini-con” featuring a full slate of firetalks, a world class CTF, as well as an organized locksport event. DHA currently boasts around 2,000 members and has a regular attendance of between 100-200 people. Wirefall is also a board member for BSides DFW, an annual security conference that attracts hundreds of attendees. He holds the position of chief consultant for the security startup, Telesploit.

Wirefall started developing his computer hacking skills back in 1982 on a dual-floppy PC with an acoustic coupler modem. He has been focused on penetration testing since the mid 90s, and his exploits have been chronicled in books such as Kevin Mitnick’s “The Art of Intrusion: The Real Stories Behind the Exploits of Hackers, Intruders and Deceivers (2005)” and Marcus J. Carey’s “Tribe of



Wirefall



Hackers: Red Team Edition (2019)". He is passionate about growing the security community through both social media and local gatherings...think global, hack local!

